# Pine Valley Special Services District

## Meeting Minutes

*Pine Valley Fire Station, 680 East Main Street, Conference Room*

## Wednesday, February 11, 2026

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| Board Members: | Bob Dalley, Chairman<br>Emily Neilson, Vice-Chair<br>Allen Cannon<br>Mark Owens<br>Steve Shakespeare (via Zoom) |
| PVSSD Assistants: | Rick Peetz, Clerk (via Zoom)<br>Teri Forbes, Treasurer |
| Others: | Frank Davie<br>Robert Hardy<br>Duane Krohn<br>Audrey Krohn<br>Tom Nielsen<br>Marc Rose (via Zoom)<br>Claudia Davis |

### 1. Welcome – Chairman Bob Dalley.

Chair Bob Dalley called the meeting to order at 7:10 PM.

### 2. Meeting Minutes.

#### A. Approval of the January 14, 2026, PVSSSD Meeting Minutes.

**Allen Cannon moved to APPROVE the minutes of January 14, 2026. Mark Owens seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

### 3. Update on Flooding and Mitigation Efforts – Mark Owens.

Mark Owens reported that the process has been slow but offered firm dates as follows from the U.S. Forest Service:

- February 26, 2026, from 12:00 PM to 4:00 PM will be a Volunteer Cleanup at the Heritage Center. Volunteers were asked to bring rakes, shovels, pruners, and other tools needed to clean the grounds.

- June 6 is National Trails Day. Training and certifications are needed to volunteer. The work will involve cleaning trails affected by the Forsyth Fire.

- July 25 is Heritage Day at Heritage Center and will feature food, booths, and demonstrations.

- September 26 is National Public Lands Day where there will be a cleanup to areas impacted by the Forsyth Fire.

The events were to be posted on Nextdoor.

Mark reported that the Heritage Center can accommodate groups of up to 75.

## 4. Report on Work Taking Place on the Dam – Mark Owens.

A total of 17 signs have been posted at the campground. District Ranger, Joe Rechsteiner, has asked that everyone stay out of the area. Logging was expected to begin in the next few weeks. Fire Chief, Robert Hardy, indicated that he would post the closure information on the bulletin board next to the station. This information has already been passed on to all the Fire Department members. Issues with the lock on the gate were discussed.

Mark reported that the logging contract is for 2026 and 2027. More basin dredging will take place this year. A contractor breached the dam and it was not known if they will do a change order or put it out to bid. Dam reconstruction was expected to take place in 2027. It was noted that no firewood is available for the community.

Mark informed the Board that the Forest Service is going to place a shed at the Heritage Center to organize volunteer parties. The Equestrian Area was expected to be open this year for horseback riding. The fish platform has been removed and is being rebuilt as part of an Eagle Scout project.

One of the issues with the project is due to there being so many reviewing agencies involved. The National Resources Conservation Service (“NCRS”) and the Army Corps of Engineers are trying to get funding, so it may take some time. The plans were received for the Emergency Watershed Project (“EWP”). There are now two water and sediment control basins because they increased the depth and size. The Forest Service has begun its review. The delays are due to the environmental permitting process. They hope to begin construction in April with the project going out to bid in March.

Property owners were encouraged to clean up their own properties and not wait for the County. 80,000 trees were planted in Gardner Peak and 60,000 in the Forsyth area. Five-foot Ponderosa Pines can be purchased for $145.

## 5. Webmaster Update – Robert Hardy.

Emily asked about the website and if the Policies and Procedures documents can be copied got new members to access. Chief Hardy suggested they obtain them from the public documents on the website. He noted that full access has been limited to six people. Joseph Hunt was asked to monitor the public documents folder and update everything with a link to the website.

## 6. Fire Department Report – Robert Hardy.

Fire Chief, Robert Hardy, reported that most of the calls last month were cancelled. The department is working on automatic aid for SR-18 for all structure fires. This will likely result in more activity in the department. Information will be updated as it is received.

Chief Hardy stated that a grateful family in the community has offered to purchase furniture for the Fire Department including two new electric reclining sofas, clerks chairs to go around the meeting table, new tables, a new desk, new bookcases, and a new printer stand. The items were expected to arrive in the next few weeks.

The furniture that is being replaced will be disposed of per the policy for disposing of surplus materials. He asked that Claudia Davis post a notice on Nextdoor with photos of the items to see if there is any interest.

Chair Dalley questioned how to deal with the potential perception that annual fees are being used to purchase furniture. Chief Hardy stated that his letter to be sent out with the Annual Assessments will address mitigation efforts and mention the new donated furnishings.

Chief Hardy reported that two Fire Department members stepped down recently and two new members joined. The current membership is 21.

**Emily Neilson moved to OFFER to the community through Nextdoor , the furniture that is being replaced with donations. Allen Cannon seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

Chief Hardy reported that fewer people attended Winter Fire School this year. The total hours were down to 267 this year compared to 410 last year. Checks were issued in December of 2024 and 2025. It seemed to be working well. All are aware that for their assessment to be returned, they must attend 50% of the trainings and 25% of the callouts. To receive the full amount of $599, they must obtain advanced certifications or be involved more than 25% of the calls. Assistant Chief, Marc Rose, keeps track of the trainings and Chief Hardy track

callouts. All call data is provided to the National Emergency Response Information System ("NERIS").

**7. Board Quarterly Bank Reconciliation Report – Bob Dalley and Allen Cannon.**

Chair Dalley reported that he, Allen Cannon, and Cortney Snow met with Rick and Teri on January 31 to review the bank reconciliations. The State in its Fraud and Risk Assessment requires this to be done. They reviewed the process and observed the reconciled bank balance per the books. The intent was to ensure that the bank statements are tied to the book accounts. They reviewed one LAD account and six SSD accounts and found no exceptions.

**8. Approve December Bank Reconciliations from January Board Meeting.**

Chair Dalley reported that approval of the December bank reconciliations was postponed. After meeting with Cortney and Allen he understood what took place.

**Chair Dalley moved to APPROVE the bank reconciliations for December 2026. Emily Neilson seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

**9. Clerk and Treasurer's Reports (January) – Rick Peetz and Teri Forbes.**

Rick Peetz presented the Clerk's Report and addressed key expenditures.

Chair Dalley asked if feedback had been received regarding the Funding Navigator app. Chief Hardy stated they have presented ideas and the process is underway to find grant funding options for various projects. One potential purchase was a side-by-side to replace the Kubota to help in rescues and other work in areas that are hard to get to. It will feature a 55-gallon water tank and a 75-foot hose.

Rick reported that the County did a very good job of collecting delinquent property taxes. Property owners are billed $30 for each invoice that is late and it is collected by the County.

A line item included the purchase of a computer for $200 by the former Treasurer that was approved by the former Chair outside the policy on surplus property.

Mark asked about shirt sales and donations. Rick explained that Claudia Davis had a Zumba class that donated money to the department.

Rick stated that money was moved from the interest-bearing operational fund to bring the capital account to $100,000. Currently, $200,000 is available to purchase equipment and $100,000 in impact fees. Funds were being saved for capital purchases.

Potential upcoming costs were discussed. Chief Hardy stated that Engine 141 is 20 years old and was purchased used. He wanted to be sure to have funds available if something catastrophic were to happen to Engine 141 in terms of providing a replacement.

Emily asked about the costs associated with the ambulance switch-over with Enterprise. The Chief stated that all that will need to be paid for is the conversion to the new radio.

Rick was preparing invoices and starting the billing process. He needs inserts consisting of letters from the Fire Chief and the Special Service District. Chair Dalley offered to draft a letter and send it out to the board for review. Chief Hardy planned to focus briefly on the Forsyth Fire and the donations used to make purchases in the fall. He'll note that there are no major capital plans for this year.

Assistant Chief Rose mentioned that this year they will try to push the importance of fire-wise landscaping, being proactive, and working together as a community to be aware of the potential for another wildland fire. The main concern is the Lloyd Canyon area. The officers have a plan to get volunteers to help clear vegetation in areas of concern.

Chief Hardy mentioned that HB-48 passed during the 2025 Legislative Session that will require high-risk areas to be mitigated to avoid financial complications. Permission was granted by Joe Rechsteiner to utilize the area behind the burn to stack vegetation instead of filling up dumpsters. They will use the chipper shredder from the County Fire Warden and make the mulch available to the community. The rest will be hauled away. This is one of the projects the Fire Department is working on to make the community more fire-wise and resilient to wildfires.

**Mark Owens moved to TABLE approval of the Clerk's Report to a date certain of March 11, 2026. Allen Cannon seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

Treasurer Teri Forbes reported that she reconciled each of the accounts and found them to be in order.

**Emily Neilson moved to APPROVE the Treasurer's Report. Mark Owens seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

## 10. Discussion on Establishing a Business Venmo Account – Allen Cannon and Bob Dalley.

Chair Dalley reported that around 700 invoices are sent out each year. Last year, 181 or 30%, paid with Venmo. Rick noted that money was also received as donations to the Fire Department and for those who lost their homes. Chair Dalley explained that although there has been absolutely no impropriety, the Venmo account has been tied to the checking account but works through cell phone numbers. The phone number associated with it was Rick and moved to former Treasurer, LaDawn Christensen. Chair Dalley was troubled by the perception it could create. Rick looked into establishing a business Venmo account. The difference is that there is a transaction fee with the cost being 1.95% of the dollar amount plus $.10. On a $250 assessment, the fee would be around $4. He asked that the board decide whether to absorb the cost. Possible options were discussed.

Rick stressed that it is necessary to have a phone and phone number to set up the account.

**Allen Cannon moved to CHANGE to a business Venmo account and purchase a cell phone line for use by the Fire Department that will be used for the business Venmo. A service fee will be passed on to cover the cost of the Venmo transaction. Mark Owens seconded the motion.**

Claudia stressed that the payor must pay the fee.

**The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

## 11. Update on Community Center Meeting with County – Allen Cannon.

Allen reported that a scheduled meeting had to be rescheduled by County Commissioner, Gil Almquist. Commissioner Almquist asked that the Board find someone to provide a second appraisal of the property. He and Mark Owens planned to prepare a summary to provide the Commissioners regarding what has taken place and discuss it at the next follow-up meeting. Mark stated that the County Commissioners have never written a letter expressing a desire to purchase the property. He planned to approach the Assistant County Attorney to push the letter through.

## 12. Citizen Requests.

Claudia suggested that when sending out letters to all homeowners, they remind them that it is their responsibility to clean up around their properties. The desire is to get everyone to make their property fire-wise. Since the fire, there are some who have still not visited their properties.

## 13. Other Business.

A question was raised about the audit, which was still in process. Chair Dalley offered to reach out to the Auditor to make sure she has everything she needs.

## 14. Adjournment.

**Emily Neilson moved to ADJOURN. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

The meeting adjourned at 8:40 PM.

The next PVSSD meeting will be on Wednesday, March 11, 2026.